



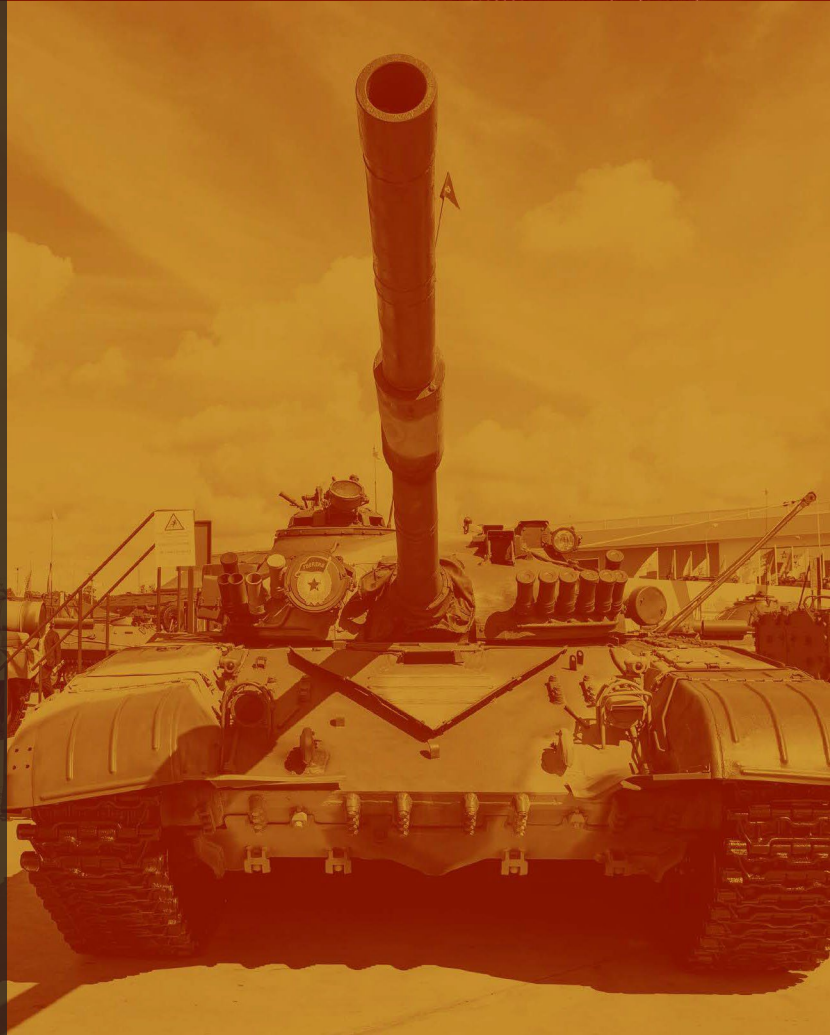
MAPPING CHINESE — AND — RUSSIAN MILITARY AND SECURITY EXPORTS TO AFRICA

— ◆ ◆ ◆ —
CORTNEY WEINBAUM

MELISSA SHOSTAK

CHANDLER SACHS

JOHN V. PARACHINI
— ◆ ◆ ◆ —



This undated photograph handed out by the French military shows three Russian mercenaries, right, in northern Mali. Russia has engaged in under-the-radar military operations in at least half a dozen countries in Africa in the past five years using a shadowy mercenary force analysts say is loyal to President Vladimir Putin. The analysts say the Wagner Group, a Russian PMSC, is also key to Putin's ambitions to reimpose Russian influence on a global scale.

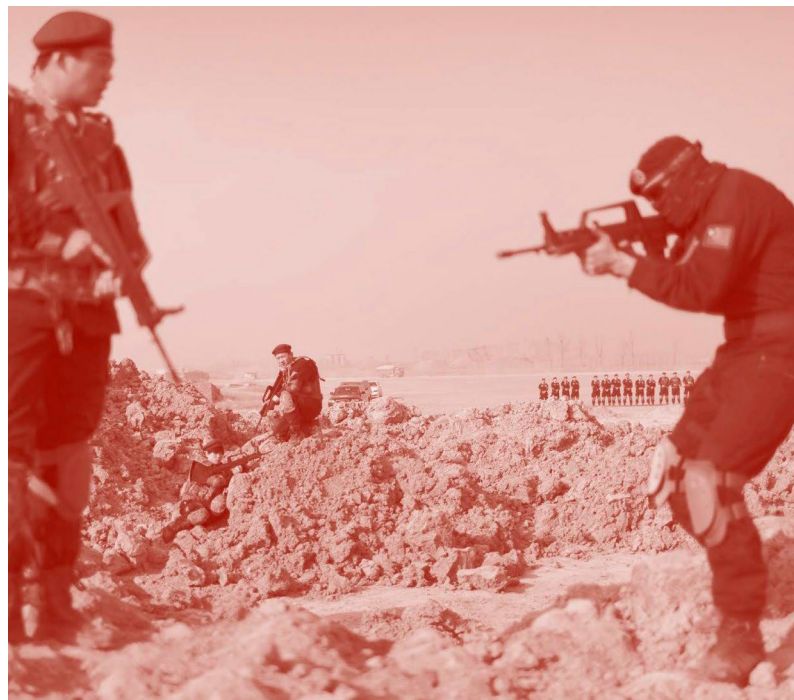


the wagner group and its owner have been sanctioned internationally, and atrocities and war crimes committed by its employees have been documented by the United Nations and various other organizations.

Military weapon exports are an important tool for projecting a country's influence around the world. Both China and Russia are among the top five countries that export major arms.¹ In addition to exporting weapons, China and Russia have employed private military and security contractors (PMSCs) across Africa. The projection of "military and security services," as PMSCs are called in the Montreux Document,² is not an "export" in the traditional, product-focused sense, yet PMSCs are an export of influence. China and Russia each use PMSCs in different ways.

Russia's most prolific PMSC is the Wagner Group, which has been involved in a variety of activities abroad, including kinetic military operations and training forces in partner nations.³ The Wagner Group increasingly operates less like a single organization and more like an umbrella of many entities, most likely under the control and direction of Russian government leaders.⁴ It is an outlier in the world of PMSCs. It is considered a mercenary group with close ties to the Russian government; the company and its owner have been sanctioned internationally; and atrocities and war crimes committed by its employees have been documented by the United Nations and various other organizations.⁵

In stark contrast, Chinese PMSCs have been employed to protect and secure China's interests in other countries, such as mining facilities, ports, and infrastructure projects. China's contractors have thus far operated primarily unarmed and engaged in defensive security functions rather than military



A bodyguard coach shows trainees how to advance with an assault rifle during a training session at the Genghis Security Academy. Nearly three dozen recruits engaged in target practice and conducted evasion and extraction drills as part of preparations to provide security for the growing number of Chinese businesses investing in turbulent regions of Africa, the Middle East, and elsewhere.

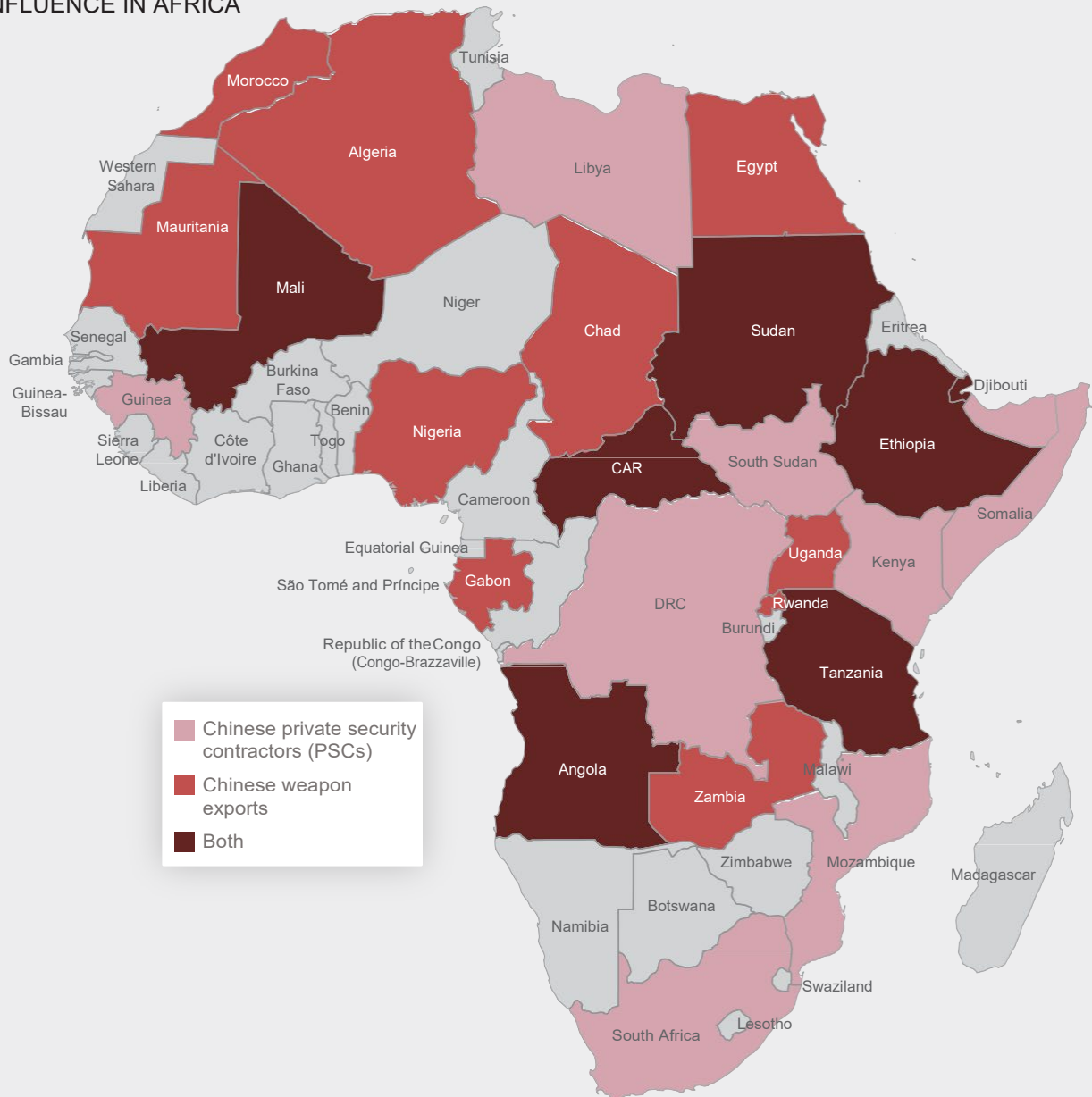
operations.⁶ China's PMSCs have similarly been closely controlled by the central government, through China's public security bureaus, though with much different aims from those of Russia's PMSCs. We have not found evidence indicating that Chinese PMSCs conduct violence or are deployed as proxy forces in manners comparable to Russia's approach.

To map the spread of China's and Russia's influence in Africa, we analyzed which African countries received military and security exports from China and Russia between 2018 and 2021.⁷ The result is the maps below, which show that both countries have been exporting defense and security influence widely across the continent.

WHERE ARE CHINA AND RUSSIA EXPORTING MILITARY AND SECURITY?

CHINA'S

MILITARY AND SECURITY INFLUENCE IN AFRICA



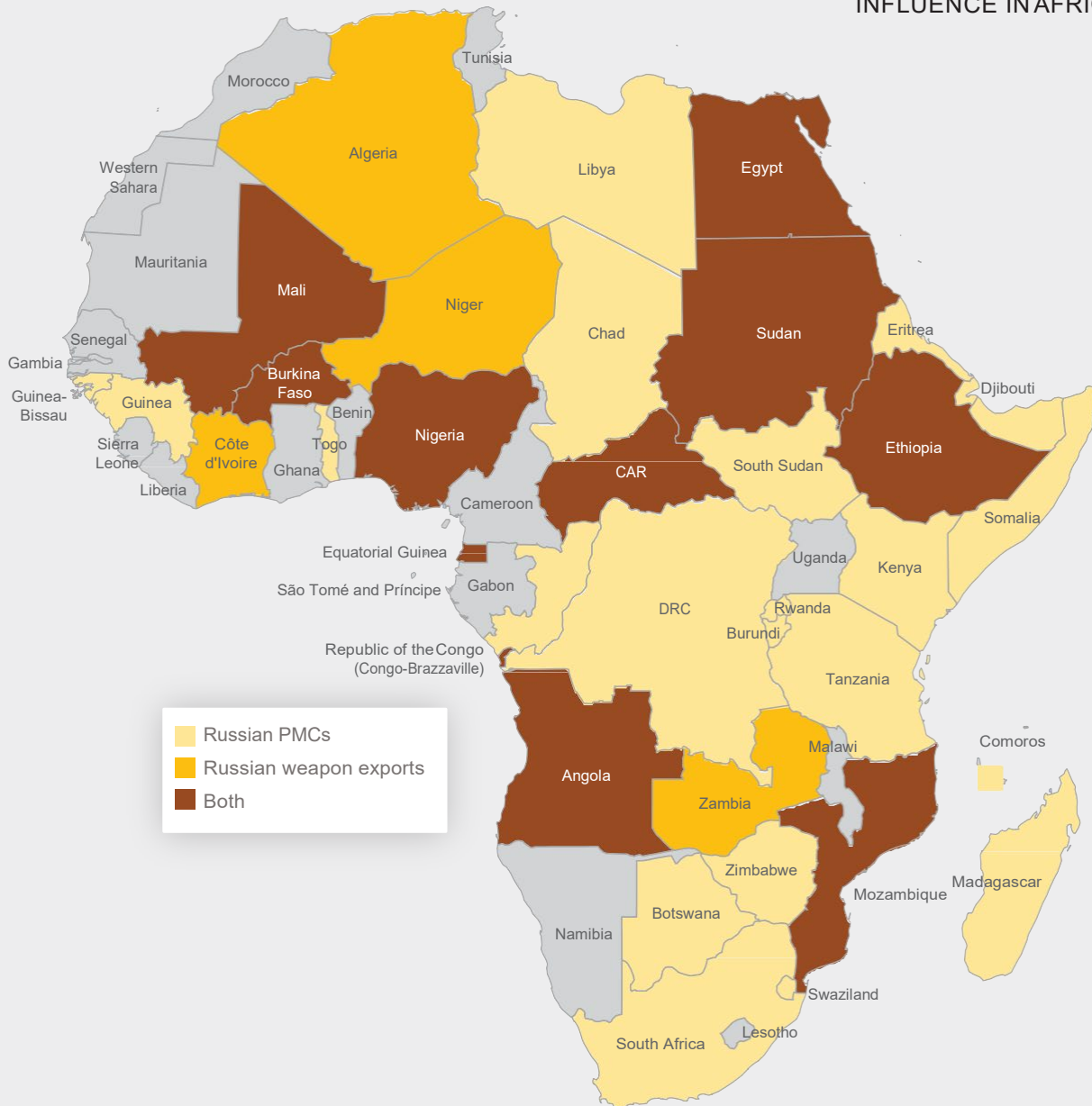
NOTE: CAR = Central African Republic; DRC = Democratic Republic of the Congo

The maps provide a visualization of China's (above) and Russia's (below) exports of weapons and PMSCs to Africa. Across Africa, 15 nations have been the destinations of Chinese PMSCs, while 31 nations have been the destinations of Russian PMSCs. Seventeen nations have been recipients

of Chinese weapons, while 14 nations have been recipients of Russian weapon systems. (These numbers do not include any relationships that do not appear in open-source literature, so it is possible that the numbers are higher.) Of these partners, seven nations have received both arms and PMSCs

RUSSIA'S

MILITARY AND SECURITY INFLUENCE IN AFRICA



NOTE: PMC = private military contractor.

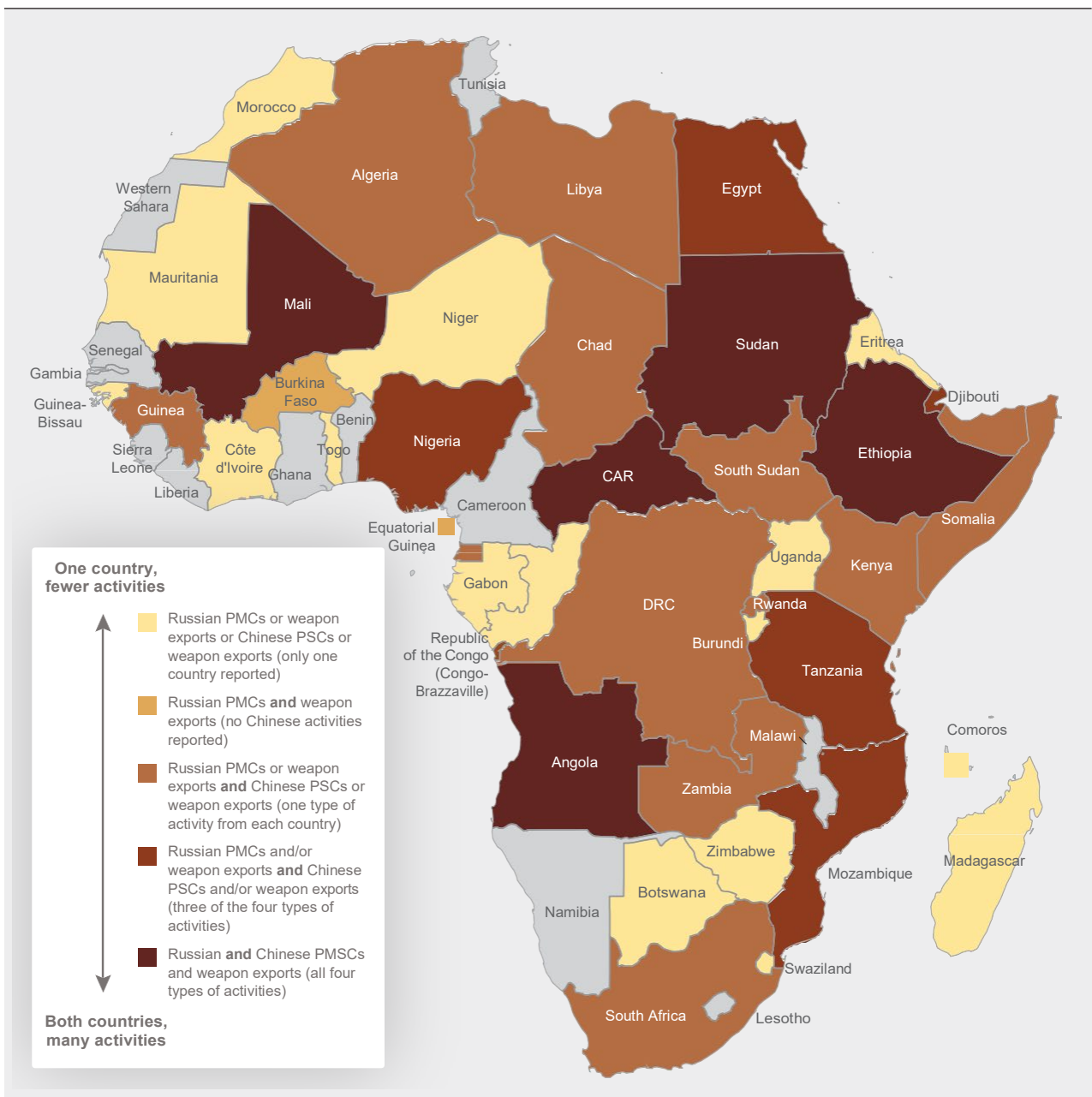
from China, while ten nations have received both arms and PMSCs from Russia. Of the two countries, Russia is the larger exporter of both arms and PMSCs.

**of the two countries, Russia is the largest
exporter of both arms and pMScs.**

The following map combines both China's and Russia's activities and influence in Africa by showing which African countries are the recipients of more military and security influence. The darkest color in the map shows five countries that received weapons and PMSCs from both China and Russia: Angola, CAR, Ethiopia, Mali, and Sudan. Lighter shades indicate less activity in a country. Countries shown in gray did not receive any weapons or PMSCs, according to our research.

Each of the 15 nations that have received Chinese PMSCs has also received Russian PMSCs. The nations that are recipients of both Chinese and Russian PMSCs are Angola, CAR, the DRC, Djibouti, Ethiopia, Guinea, Kenya, Libya, Mali, Mozambique, Somalia, South Africa, South Sudan, Sudan, and Tanzania. China and Russia sell arms to nine of the same nations.

WHERE ARE CHINA AND RUSSIA EXPORTING MILITARY AND SECURITY?



The following table shows the data used to create these maps. It delineates arms exports by the types of weapons purchased by each country.⁸

MILITARY AND SECURITY EXPORTS TO AFRICA

Which Countries Receive Which Exports?

											
ALGERIA	PSCs	AIRCRAFT AND UAVs	AIR DEFENSE SYSTEMS	ARTILLERY	ARMORED VEHICLES	ENGINES	MISSILES	OTHER	SATELLITES	SENSORS	SHIPS
		R C		C	R		R C			C	R
ANGOLA	R C	R C									
BOTSWANA	R										
BURKINA FASO	R	R									
BURUNDI	R										
CAR	R C				R C						
CHAD	R										
COMOROS	R										
CÔTE D'IVOIRE						R					
DJIBOUTI	R C						C				C
DRC	R C										
E. AFRICAN COAST	R										
EGYPT	R	R C					R C		R		
EQUATORIAL GUINEA	R	R									
ERITREA	R										
ETHIOPIA	R C		R	C			R C				
GABON					C						
GUINEA	R C										
GUINEA-BISSAU	R										
KENYA	R C										
LIBYA	R C										
MADAGASCAR	R										
MALI	R	R									
MAURITANIA											C
MOROCCO			C								
MOZAMBIQUE	R C	R									
NIGER		R									
NIGERIA	R	R C		C	C	R	R				
REPUBLIC OF THE CONGO	R										
RWANDA	R			C			C				
SOMALIA	R C										
SOUTH AFRICA	R C										
SOUTH SUDAN	R C										
SUDAN	R C		C			R		C			
SWAZILAND	R										
TANZANIA	R C				C					C	
TOGO	R										
UGANDA					C						
ZAMBIA					R C						
ZIMBABWE	R										

	Russian PMCs		Chinese PSCs
	Russian weapon exports		Chinese weapon exports
	Both Russian PMCs and weapon exports		Both Chinese PSCs and weapon exports

NOTE: UAV = unmanned aerial vehicle.

APPENDIX

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- ⁷ Some readers who are familiar with the Montreux Document might question whether this map indicates *territorial states* (states on whose territory PMSCs operate) or *contracting states* (states that directly contract for the services of PMSCs). The maps in this tool provide an overview of all territorial states without distinguishing which states are also contracting states. Data to conduct such an analysis are not readily available, since the ultimate client and purpose of each PMSC’s activities in a country are often not publicly revealed.
- ⁸ The definitions for the types of weapon systems can be found at Stockholm International Peace Research Institute, “Coverage,” webpage, undated.

ABOUT THIS TOOL

This tool provides a visualization of China's and Russia's military and security influence in Africa. RAND Corporation researchers examined publicly available data and literature on both China's and Russia's weapon exports and use of private military and security contractors in Africa to identify recipient countries during 2018–2021. This visualization provides an analytic tool to researchers and analysts examining and comparing China's and Russia's defense and security influence.

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